

TMC 221 • TOTAL MAN CONCEPT

Goal Setting and Personal Accomplishment

Proven frameworks for turning Ambition into Achievement

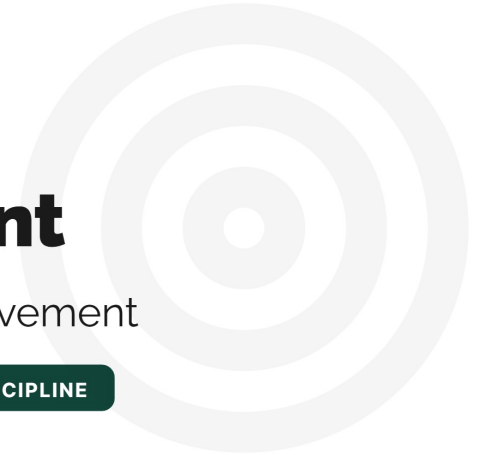
GOAL SETTING

ACHIEVEMENT

FRAMEWORKS

IDENTITY

DISCIPLINE



Same Starting Line — Completely Different Finish

Two students, same university, one critical difference

In 2008, two Covenant University roommates each wrote about their futures.

The first wrote: *"I want to be successful."*

The second wrote a precise plan — a certification, an NGO role, and ₦500,000 saved — all by a specific date.

By 2012, the second had done **all three**. The first was still writing the same sentence.

The difference was not intelligence, family background, or luck.

It was **clarity**.

"The indispensable first step to getting what you want is this: decide what you want."

— Ben Stein

What You Will Be Able to Do

Four outcomes from this session

1 Distinguish

between wishes, dreams, intentions, and properly structured goals

2 Apply

at least two evidence-based goal-setting frameworks to your personal life

3 Identify

the psychology behind achievement and why goals fail

4 Build

a personal goal architecture using proven modern strategies



Not Every Aspiration Is a Goal

The four levels — and why most people never leave level two

LEVEL	EXAMPLE	THE PROBLEM
Wish	"I want to be rich"	No direction or deadline
Dream	"I want to own a business someday"	Indefinite timeframe
Intention	"I plan to start saving this year"	No commitment or measure
Goal	"I will save ₦20,000 monthly for 6 months from Jan 1st"	Specific, measurable, time-bound

Most people live in the **Wish** and **Dream** layers — they feel purposeful without requiring anything of themselves.

A real goal is a *declaration with evidence* — what will happen, when, and how you will know.

Key shift: Move from "I want" to "I will — by [date] — measured by [evidence]."

Three Types of Goals — Only One Actually Changes You

Outcome, Process, and Identity — ranked by lasting power

Outcome Goals

What you want to achieve

"Win the department prize."

Motivating — but entirely
outside your daily control.

⚠ Useful for direction.
Dangerous alone.

Process Goals

What you commit to doing

"Study four hours every
weekday."

Fully **within your control**
and builds directly toward
outcomes.

✓ The daily engine of
achievement.

Identity Goals

Who you are becoming

"I am the kind of person who
shows up consistently."

When the goal becomes
your **identity**, behaviour
follows without negotiation.

🧑 The student who *is*
disciplined outlasts the
one who *wants* to be.



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What Type Is Your Goal?

Five minutes to examine and upgrade one current goal

Work individually. Be honest — this is for you.

1. Write down one current goal you are actively pursuing (or avoiding).
2. Identify its type: **Outcome**, **Process**, or **Identity**?
3. Rewrite it as an Identity Goal: *"I am becoming the kind of person who..."*
4. Notice how the rewrite feels — does it land differently?

Four Frameworks That Actually Work

Each solves a different failure mode — together they build a system

#	FRAMEWORK	THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES
1	SMART+ER	Goals that lack structure and emotional connection
2	OKRs	Ambition with no measurable evidence of progress
3	12-Week Year	Annual planning that destroys urgency
4	Implementation Intentions	Motivation without a trigger to act

Use these as a toolkit — not as a menu to pick one from.

1. The SMART Framework — Works But it Has a Fatal Weakness

Add two letters that prevent emotional disconnection and abandonment

S — Specific: Exactly what will you do or produce?

M — Measurable: What number proves you succeeded?

A — Achievable: Is this a genuine but realistic stretch?

R — Relevant: Does this serve your bigger purpose?

T — Time-bound: What is the exact deadline?

+E — *Exciting*: Would you pursue this without anyone watching?

+R — *Reviewed*: When exactly will you check progress?

Why the upgrade matters:

A SMART goal can be abandoned by week 2 — because No **emotionally connection**.

E = Internal fuel. **R** builds in accountability.

A goal without a review schedule is a wish with an expiry date.

2. The OKR Structure — Ambition Meets Evidence

Used by Google since 1999 — works just as well for one person

An **OKR** has two parts:

1 Objective

One bold, inspiring, *qualitative* statement. Answers: "*Where am I going?*" Ambitious enough to feel slightly uncomfortable.

2 Key Results (2–4)

Specific, measurable outcomes that *prove* the Objective was achieved. Answers: "*How will I know I got there?*"

Critical distinction:

A Key Result is **not an activity**.

⊗ "Attend networking events" — activity

✓ "Secure 3 mentors by end of quarter" = **Key Result**

Activities describe what you do. Key Results describe what changes.

Adaeze's OKR — From Vague to Verified

How a 300-Level Mass Comm student built her professional profile

Objective: *Establish myself as a credible emerging voice in digital media before the end of this academic year.*

✓ **KR 1:** Publish 12 posts (min. 200 views each) — by Apr 30

✓ **KR 2:** Complete one freelance project with external published output by June 30

✓ **KR 3:** Secure 2 active industry mentors — 1 conversation/month — by March 31

✓ **KR 4:** Grow LinkedIn to 500 connections at 3% engagement by May 31

**End-of-Quarter Score =
0.76 (Strong)**

|| 12 posts → 0.75 (published 9)

|| Internship → 1.0

|| 2 Mentors → 0.5 (found 1)

|| LinkedIn → 0.8 (reached 412)

Scoring replaces vague guilt with a structured conversation about what changes next quarter.

3. 12-Week Year Framework

Compress execution into 12-week cycles — get four fresh starts per year

The five elements of a 12-Week cycle:

- 1 Vision**
Your long-term *why* that doesn't change weekly
- 2 12-Week Goal**
One to three specific goals for this cycle only
- 3 Weekly Plan — Specific scheduled actions per week**
written, not mental
- 4 Weekly Scorecard**
% of planned actions completed. Target: **85%+**
- 5 Weekly Review**
What worked? What changes next week?

When you have 12 months to achieve a goal, your brain behaves as though there is **always more time.**

Urgency is low in Jan.
Relevance fades in Jun.
Panic arrives in Oct — too late for a full recovery.

Brian Moran's Solution:
Treat every 12 weeks as a Full Year.**

4. Implementation Intentions

Pre-Decide — So Your Future Self Doesn't Negotiate

Psychologist **Peter Gollwitzer** found that people who specified *when* and *where* they would act followed through **two to three times more often** than those who only stated strong intentions.

The formula:

"When [specific cue] occurs, I will [specific behaviour]."

The cue must be **concrete** — a time, place, or completed action. Not *"when I feel motivated."*

71%

Completion rate when people specified exactly when and where they would act (vs. 32% with intention only).

How to use Implementation Intentions

- 1 Name the goal behaviour : One specific action**
- 2 Identify your failure mode: When and why it typically doesn't happen**
- 3 Find a reliable daily cue": Time, Place, or Existing routine**
- 4 Write the if-then plan: When [cue], I will [action]**
- 5 Pre-empt the obstacle: If [TEMPTATION], then I will [COUNTER-ACTION]**
- 6 Chain it to an existing habit for automatic triggering**

Build One Implementation Intention

Five minutes to pre-decide your most important behaviour

For your most important current goal:

1. What is the **specific behaviour** the goal requires — one concrete action?
2. What is your **most predictable failure mode** — when and why do you typically not do it?
3. Write your **Implementation Intention**: "*When I will.*"
4. Write your **Obstacle Plan**: "*If happens, then I will.*"
5. Connect it to an existing habit: "*After I [habit] → I will [goal action].*"

Three Reasons Goals Fail — None of Them Is Laziness

The science behind why even motivated students give up

1. Planning Fallacy

We overestimate what we can do short-term and underestimate long-term capacity.

40%

Fix: Add a 40% time buffer. Work backwards from the deadline.

2. Motivation Decay

Motivation peaks at the start and end. Weeks 3–8 — the dangerous middle — is when most people quit.

Fix: Design your system for the middle, not the launch.

3. Willpower Depletion

Self-control tires with use. Relying on willpower alone is a losing strategy.

Fix: Design your environment so the right behaviour needs least resistance.

Six Strategies That Sustain Goals When Motivation Fades

Environment and **Systems**, not Willpower and Inspiration

↻ **Habit Stacking** — Attach a new goal behaviour to an existing daily habit

😊 **Temptation Bundling** — Pair a hard task with something you enjoy. Research: +51% exercise when bundled with audiobooks

▶ **The 2-Minute Rule** — Commit to just 2 minutes of a hard task. The goal is to *start*, not to finish

↗ **Progress Principle** — Small wins are the biggest driver of motivation (Harvard, Amabile). Keep a daily progress journal

👤 **Accountability** — A structured accountability partner raises goal completion to **95%** (ASTD)

👁 **WOOP** — Wish, Outcome, Obstacle, Plan. Mental contrasting outperforms positive visualisation

WOOP — Visualise the Win, Then Plan the Obstacle

The four-step method that outperforms pure positive thinking

1 Wish

State your most important goal clearly and specifically

2 Outcome

Visualise the best possible result vividly. How does it feel when you get there?

3 Obstacle

Name the biggest *internal* obstacle honestly. What has stopped you before?

4 Plan

Write the if-then response: "*If [obstacle], then I will [specific action].*"

Example:

☆ **Wish:** Finish my research proposal this month

👁️ **Outcome:** Supervisor approves it; I feel proud and ahead of schedule

⚠️ **Obstacle:** I get distracted by social media when working alone

🛡️ **Plan:** When I sit to write, I switch my phone to airplane mode first

Winning in One Area While Losing in Another Is Not Success

The **Total Man Concept** demands whole-life excellence

The Total Man framework covers every domain:

-  **Spiritual** — Formation, calling, and purpose
-  **Mental** — Academic excellence and intellectual growth
-  **Physical** — Health, discipline, and bodily stewardship
-  **Social** — Relationships, community, and service
-  **Financial** — Stewardship and wealth-building discipline

Three questions for aligned goal setting:

Does this goal serve my **purpose**, not just my preference?

Am I building in **every dimension**, or winning in one while crumbling in others?

Is this goal aligned with **who God has called me to be**?

The 4-Layer Goal Stack — Vision to Action This Week

Nested commitments across time that feed each other

LAYER	TIMEFRAME	THE QUESTION
Life Vision	10–20 years	Who am I called to be?
Strategic Goals	1–3 years	What must I build toward that vision?
Quarterly Targets	12 weeks	What do I commit to right now?
Weekly Actions	7 days	What do I actually do this week?

Each layer feeds the one above it. Weekly actions are not random — they are the bricks that build the vision.

Example — 200-Level Student:

 **Vision:** Lead political reform in West Africa

 **Strategic:** First class + MPA or LAW scholarship by 2030

 **Quarterly:** Raise CGPA 0.2 points this semester

 **Weekly:** Notes done Fri, study group Sat 10am

Build Your 4-Layer Goal Stack

Eight minutes — from your life vision to your action this week

Work independently. Start from the top and work down.

1. **Life Vision:** Who are you called to be? What legacy will you leave? Write 2 sentences — not a job title, but a person description.
2. **Strategic Goal:** What must you build or achieve in the next 3 years toward that vision?
3. **Quarterly Target:** One specific, measurable commitment for the next 12 weeks.
4. **Weekly Action:** One concrete action this week — write the day, time, and location.
5. **Pair share:** Read only your Weekly Action to the person beside you. Exchange contacts. Agree to check in before next lecture.